INCH-POUND

A-A-20199
June 30, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHICKEN BREAST FILLET WITH RIB MEAT, SEASONED, CHUNKED AND FORMED, GRILLED, THERMOPROCESSED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers thermostabilized, grilled, chunked and formed, seasoned chicken breast fillet with rib meat, packed in flexible pouches, suitable for use by the Federal Government and as a component of the Meal, Ready-To-Eat.

Salient characteristics.

Ingredients used for the grilled chunked and formed seasoned chicken breast fillet with rib meat (chicken fillet) shall be chunked chicken breast meat with rib meat, water, modified food starch, salt, grill flavor, dextrose, sodium phosphate, onion and garlic powder, autolyzed yeast, and antioxidants.

A. Poultry. Only breast meat with rib meat shall be used in this product. The chickens from which the breast and rib meat are derived shall be fresh chilled broilers, fryers, or roasters. The breast and rib meat shall not be frozen before forming into the raw chicken fillet. All poultry meat must be in accordance with the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Part 381).

1. Sampling. The poultry meat shall be sampled and examined for organoleptic requirements and defects before formulation or size reduction. The number of samples examined will be those outlined in the applicable U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) Poultry Division acceptable quality level (AQL) sample plan. If any sample does not comply with the organoleptic requirements or has more defects than the

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: SATNC-WTP, Natick, MA 01760-5018.

FSC 8905

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

maximum tolerance for the AQL sample plan, the product or the lot the sample represents will be rejected for use in preparation of the grilled chicken breast fillet.

2. Organoleptic requirements. The poultry meat must be free of rancidity; must be free of fruity, sulfide-like, cardboardy, tallowy, painty, oily, oxidized, metallic, or other off or foreign odors; must show no evidence of mishandling or deterioration; and must have a bright color with no evidence of dehydration or freezing and thawing.

3. Tolerance for defects. Samples shall not exceed the tolerances for defects listed in Table I.

TABLE I. Poultry defects

Defects
1. A flesh bruise on the meat which exceeds an area equivalent to the area of a circle with a diameter of 0.25 inch (0.64 cm).
2. A defect for discoloration in the meat is when the aggregate area of all discolorations, which are moderate in intensity, exceeds an area equivalent to the area of a circle having a diameter of 1 inch (2.54 cm).
3. Bone or bone-like material.
4. Cartilage (gristle), tendon or tendinous material extending more than 0.50 inch (1.27 cm) beyond the meat tissue.
5. Dark colored (due to blood) artery or vein more than 1 inch (2.54 cm) in length.
6. Blood clots which exceed an area equivalent to a circle with a diameter of 0.25 inch (0.64 cm).
7. Skin on meat exceeding an area equivalent to the area of a circle with the diameter of 1 inch (2.54 cm).

B. Other ingredients. All other ingredients used in the chicken fillet shall be food grade quality and shall be approved by the Food and Drug Administration.

Preparation and processing.

All preparation and processing shall occur subsequent to the date of award. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

produced, processed, and stored in plants operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of USDA. The temperature of ready-to-cook poultry and poultry products, size reduced meat, and the individual grilled chicken breast fillet products must also comply with 9 CFR Part 381. Fresh chilled poultry, poultry parts, or poultry meat which have been shipped between plants shall be at an internal temperature not higher than 40°F (4.4°C) and not lower than 26°F (-3.3°C) when shipped from the origin plant and when received at the destination plant. Poultry shall be shipped to arrive at the destination plant within 6 days after initial chilling. Within this timeframe, deboned meat from chickens and chicken parts must be fabricated into raw chicken breast fillets within 4 days after deboning. When shipped between plants, a USDA Poultry Products Grading Certificate or other USDA certification stating class, style, condition, and processing date must accompany each shipment. The breast meat with rib meat must be reduced in size through a plate with openings that are not less than 0.75 inch (1.91 cm) in the smallest dimension. Meat may be chopped to an equivalent size by other methods when the methods are reviewed and found acceptable by a supervisory representative of the Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, USDA. Mechanically deboned (comminuted) and/or finely ground meat shall be excluded from use in this product. The formed raw chicken fillet shall be either frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F (-17.8°C) or below within 72 hours after forming and held for not more than 90 days prior to cooking, or cooked immediately after forming.

Cooking. The raw chicken fillet shall be cooked by any method or combination of methods allowed by the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations so as to comply with the finished product and analytical requirements. An internal product temperature of not less than 160°F (71.1°C) shall be obtained during cooking. If destined for frozen storage, the cooked chicken fillet shall be frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F (-17.8°C) or below within 72 hours of cooking and held for not more than 180 days until further processing.

Pouch filling and sealing. Each pouch shall be filled with one chicken fillet so as to conform to the finished product requirements. The internal temperature of the chicken fillet at time of filling shall be 26°F (-3.3°C) to 40°F (4.4°C) if not filled immediately after cooking. Frozen chicken fillets shall be tempered/thawed only to the extent necessary to accommodate the filling operation.

Thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed pouch shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after sealing and shall be thermoprocessed by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

Finished product requirements.

The finished product shall have a characteristic slightly spicy, slightly salty grilled chicken flavor and a smoked, grilled chicken aroma. The product shall be free from off-flavors and off-odors. The texture shall be that of

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

chunked and formed chicken breast and the fillet shall be cohesive, moist and tender, not dry, mushy, or rubbery. The skinless and boneless fillets shall have a moist appearance with a brownish gold color and brown grill marks. There shall be no evidence of excessive heating (darkened or scorched). The fillet shall have a natural chicken breast shape. The fillets shall be not more than 3.25 inches (8.26 cm) at the greatest width and not more than 4.5 inches (11.43 cm) at the greatest length. Each fillet shall weigh not less than 4.0 ounces (113.40 g). Each fillet shall comply with the following analytical requirements:

	Minimum	Maximum
Total fat (percent)	6.0	8.0
Salt (NaCl, percent)	1.0	2.0

Reworked product. Cooked product which has not been frozen and which is wholesome and salvageable but (1) is misshaped, (2) is fractured (separated into two or more pieces), or (3) does not meet the formed width, length, and weight requirements may be reworked into raw formulated product at a maximum level of 2 percent provided it is blended in accordance with Food Safety and Inspection Service, USDA procedures, and complies with the organoleptic and defect requirements for raw product.

Analytical requirements.

Three filled, sealed, and thermoprocessed pouches shall be selected at random, by the USDA grader, from the lot regardless of lot size and tested for fat and salt content. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result not conforming to the finished product requirements, as indicated by a USDA certificate, shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Analyses shall be made in accordance with the following methods of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC:

Test	Method Number
Fat	960.39, 976.21, or 985.15
Salt	935.47

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace. Delivered product shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Products Inspection Acts and regulations promulgated thereunder. Delivered product shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the quality assurance for the grilled chicken breast fillet shall be determined by the Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, USDA, in accordance with USDA procedures. The product shall be examined and/or tested for conformance to the product requirements in this CID and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The grilled chicken breast fillet shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and cases marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements (Only).

Packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The grilled chicken breast fillet shall be filled and sealed into a heat sealable flexible pouch, thermoprocessed, unit packed into paperboard cartons, and packed for shipment in accordance with Class 3 of MIL-P-44073, Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches. Labeling of pouches, marking of paperboard cartons, and marking of shipping containers shall be in accordance with MIL-P-44073.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Notes.

Sources of documents.

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC may be obtained from:

AOAC International
2200 Wilson Boulevard
Suite 400
Arlington, VA 22201-3301

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations are contained in 9 CFR Parts 200 to end. The Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act can be found in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. These documents may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit Card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Copies of Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches (MIL-P-44073) are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - SA, MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

(Project 8905-1119)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.